

OAS-020 — Intent Architecture

Status: Foundational

Authority: Architectural

Depends on:

- OAS-000 through OAS-019
 - OCS-000 through OCS-032
-

Purpose

This specification defines the architectural organization of Intent.

Intent is the architectural expression of purpose before action.

Events describe what happened.

Decisions describe what was chosen.

Intent explains why movement began.

Architecture SHALL preserve Intent independently of outcomes.

Understanding the purpose behind an action is as constitutionally important as understanding the action itself.

1. Architectural Objective

The objective of Intent Architecture is to preserve the constitutional purpose that motivates architectural evolution.

Architecture SHALL preserve:

Purpose.

Direction.

Motivation.

Context.

Expected outcomes.

Known uncertainty.

Intent SHALL remain reconstructable.

2. Definition

Architectural Intent is the explicit constitutional declaration of the purpose underlying a future constitutional action.

Intent MAY originate from:

Participants.

Voices.

Places.

Conversations.

Experiments.

Architectural evolution.

Intent SHALL precede commitment.

3. Intent Independence

Intent SHALL remain independent of:

Execution.

Success.

Failure.

Authority.

Implementation strategy.

Intent SHALL preserve purpose regardless of outcome.

4. Intent Relationships

Intent SHALL maintain explicit relationships with:

Questions.

Evidence.

Reasoning.

Understanding.

Decisions.

Actions.

Observed outcomes.

Relationships SHALL remain reconstructable.

5. Intent Evolution

Intent MAY evolve.

Evolution SHALL preserve:

Original purpose.

Reason for change.

Historical continuity.

Architectural context.

Intent evolution SHALL become constitutional history.

6. Multiple Intentions

Architecture SHALL support multiple concurrent Intentions.

Intentions MAY:

Cooperate.

Compete.

Complement one another.

Remain unresolved.

Architecture SHALL preserve every constitutionally relevant Intent.

7. Intent Transparency

Intent SHALL remain explicitly observable.

Hidden Intent SHALL constitute architectural incompleteness.

Participants SHALL be able to distinguish:

Declared Intent.

Observed Action.

Observed Consequence.

These SHALL remain architecturally separate.

8. Intent and Federation

Intent MAY extend across multiple Places.

Federation SHALL preserve:

Local purpose.

Shared objectives.

Independent interpretation.

Relationship continuity.

Intent SHALL remain locally attributable.

9. Intent Memory

Architectural Memory SHALL preserve:

Declared intentions.

Evolution.

Associated Decisions.

Observed outcomes.

Subsequent learning.

Intent Memory SHALL support future reflection.

10. Intent Verification

Verification SHALL demonstrate:

Purpose preservation.

Relationship preservation.

Historical reconstruction.

Architectural continuity.

Equivalent constitutional Intent behavior.

Implementation SHALL remain replaceable.

11. Intent Pattern

Architecture SHALL organize future-oriented constitutional behavior around explicit Intent rather than implicit expectation.

Expectation predicts.

Intent declares purpose.

Architecture SHALL preserve declaration.

12. Intent Architecture Test

Intent Architecture satisfies this specification when an independent architect can reconstruct:

Why a constitutional process began.

Which purpose motivated it.

How that purpose evolved.

How Decisions reflected it.

How Actions expressed it.

How outcomes differed from intentions.

Without relying on implementation-specific workflow.

Conformance

An implementation conforms to this specification when Intent remains explicit, historically attributable, architecturally reconstructable, and constitutionally distinguishable from decisions, actions, and outcomes.

Architectural Principle

Actions reveal what happened.

Intent reveals why the future was invited to change.

Architecture therefore preserves Intent,
because a civilization that remembers only its actions
will eventually forget the purposes that once gave those actions meaning.

End of Specification OAS-020